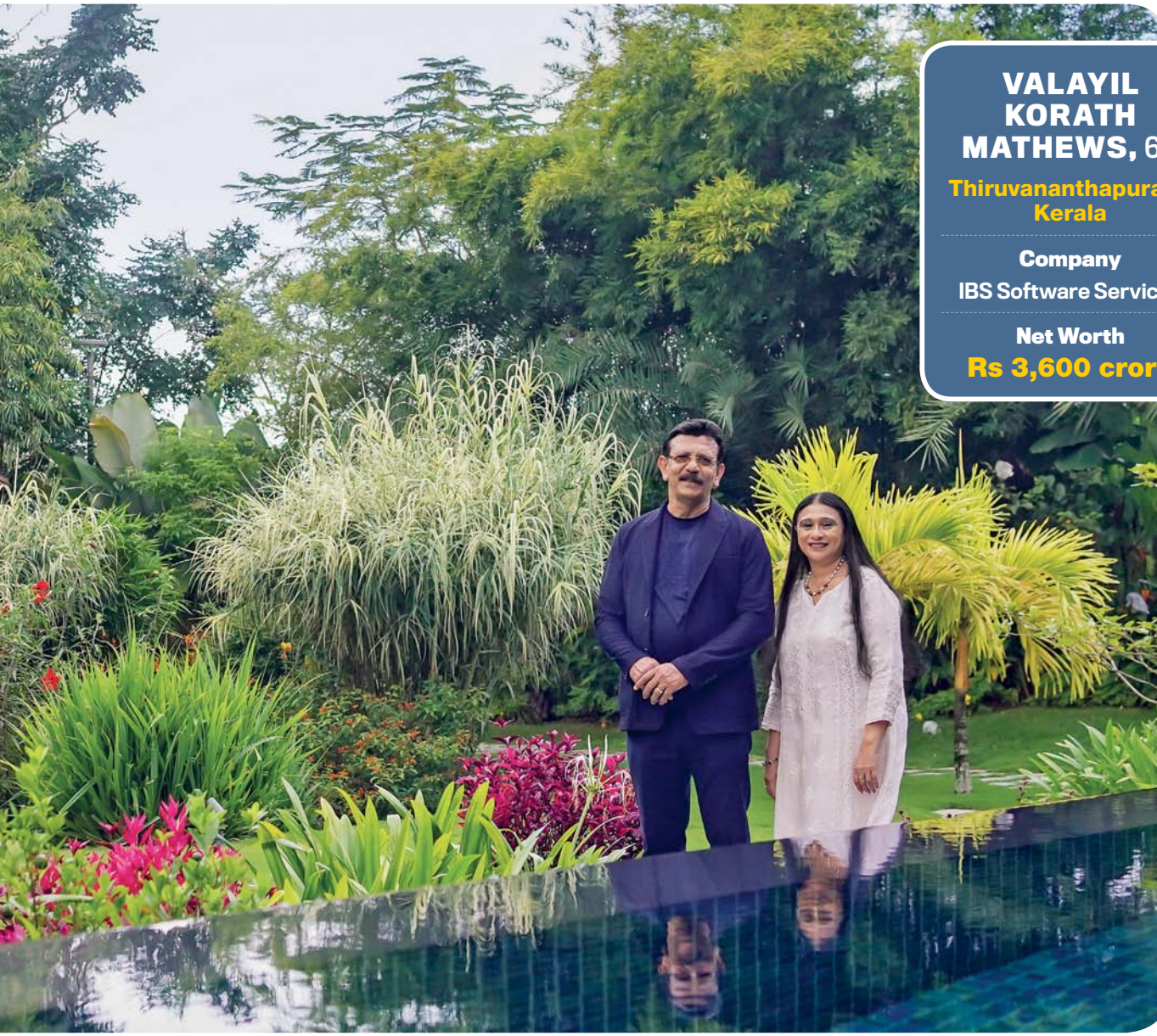


VALAYIL KORATH MATHEWS, 65

Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala

Company

IBS Software Services

Net Worth

Rs 3,600 crore

ASHISH K. VINCENT



MARINE MAGNATE

TARA RANJAN PATNAIK, 70

Bhubaneswar, Odisha

Company

Falcon Marine Exports Ltd

Net Worth

Rs 1,200 crore

His lawyer father wasn't exactly happy when the then 22-year-old Patnaik announced he wanted to go fishing on a deep-sea trawler. The prospect of earning Rs 25,000 a day in the 70s was tempting; the state government, too, was promoting fisheries with easy loans. Patnaik borrowed Rs 5,000 from a cousin and Rs 2 lakh from the Odisha State Financial Corporation to buy a trawler. A spate of losses later, he began delivering shrimp to his friends, who were supplying to food chains like ITC and Britannia.

He got his own licence in 1980 and opened Falcon Marine. Back then, he had to first build roads before he could transport the marine produce from the sea to the processing station. Today, he has 3,500 acres devoted to shrimp farming, five modern processing plants, which can process 150 tonnes of shrimp daily. He has also beefed up the supply and logistics chain, including cold storage and warehousing facilities. Patnaik also has a team of contract farmers to cultivate prawns in keeping with export standards—fresh and antibiotic-free. In the '80s, when FMEL was exporting prawn and seafood to Japan, its annual turnover was Rs 40-50 lakh. Today, the company has an estimated turnover of Rs 2,800 crore. He has shared the prosperity with his neighbours in Keonjhar, ensuring they have pucca houses "so that neither they nor I feel out of place".

-Romita Datta